VEL
SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS

CONTROLLED TEMPLATES

QA Templates & Sign-off Checklist Pack

Test strategy, test plan, test case, scenario, defect report, execution report, traceability, automation coverage, performance, UAT and release sign-off

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1. Templates and QA Sign-off Checklist

Controlled templates for every document in the lifecycle. Copy the Markdown or CSV version from `qa-project-template/` into the project repository; the forms below show the required fields. Grey hint text describes what to enter — delete it when filling in.

HOW TO USE A TEMPLATE

- Copy it, fill every field or write "N/A — reason"; never leave a field silently blank.
- Keep the header block (ID, version, status, author, reviewer, date) and update it on every change.
- Store the file in the path shown; commit with a message such as `docs(test-plan): v0.2 add risks`.
- Evidence and attachments are referenced by file name or link, with secrets removed.

Test Strategy

Purpose: Defines how testing will be done and why (Stage 03). **Repository file:** `docs/test-strategy.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
1. Purpose and scope	*What quality objectives does this strategy serve? What is in/out of scope?*
2. Product overview	*Users, key workflows, architecture summary, integrations.*

3. Risks and test responses

ID	Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Test response	Owner

4. Test levels and types	*Which of: functional, regression, integration, E2E, API, database, cross-browser, mobile, accessibility, performance, security coordination, UAT support.*
5. Environments and test data	*Environments, owners, refresh rules, synthetic data approach, privacy rules.*
6. Browser / device / OS matrix	*Taken from client analytics; mark minimum versions.*
7. Automation approach	*What is automated, tools, framework, CI, reporting, maintenance.*

8. Tools and licences	*Tool, version, licence, cost, approver.*
9. Defect management	*Tracker, workflow, severity/priority scales, triage cadence.*
10. Metrics and reporting	*Metrics with formulas, cadence, audience.*
11. Non-functional targets	*Performance, accessibility (WCAG version/level), reliability targets.*
12. Security-testing boundary	*What QA checks; named security coordinator; escalation route.*
13. Roles and responsibilities	*Who does what; reviewer ≠ author.*
14. Assumptions, dependencies, exclusions	*Written and agreed.*
15. Approvals	*Test Manager, client representative, date, signature.*

Test Plan

Purpose: Turns the strategy into a schedule, resources, criteria and risks (Stage 04). **Repository file:** `docs/test-plan.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
1. Introduction and objectives	*What this plan covers and what success means.*
2. Scope	*In scope (features/REQ IDs, platforms) and out of scope.*
3. Test items and builds	*Application versions, build numbers, delivery dates.*
4. Approach	*Types of testing and techniques per area; automation plan.*

5. Schedule and milestones

Milestone	Start	End	Owner	Gate

6. Resources	*Roles, names, allocation (hours/percent).*
7. Test environment	*URLs, accounts, data, tools; link to test-environment.md.*

8. Entry criteria	*Measurable, e.g. build deployed, smoke passed, data loaded.*
9. Exit criteria	*Measurable, e.g. 100 % critical cases executed; no open S1/S2 without written acceptance.*
10. Suspension / resumption criteria	*When testing stops and what restarts it.*
11. Deliverables	*Which documents and reports will be produced and when.*
12. Communication and reporting	*Daily status, weekly report, triage meetings.*
13. Change control	*How scope/schedule changes are raised, estimated and approved.*
14. Approvals	*Test Manager, client PM, date, signature.*

Risks and mitigations

ID	Risk	Mitigation	Owner	Due

Test Scenario

Purpose: High-level conditions to test; cases are derived from them. **Repository file:** `test-cases/scenarios.csv`

Scenario ID	*TS-<area>-<nn>*
Title	*Verify that ...*
Requirement ID(s)	*REQ-nnn*
Priority / type	*High·Medium·Low / functional·negative·...*
Derived test case IDs	*TC-...*

Scenario list

Scenario ID	Title (Verify that ...)	REQ ID(s)	Priority	Type	Derived TC IDs

Test Case

Purpose: One precise, repeatable verification. **Repository file:** `test-cases/functional/<feature>.csv`

Test case ID	*TC-<area>-<nnn>*
Title	*One verification, stated positively*
Requirement ID(s)	*REQ-nnn*
Module / type / technique	*e.g. Registration / functional / BVA*
Priority	*High · Medium · Low*
Preconditions	*State of system and data before the test*
Test data	*Exact values*
Steps	*1. … 2. … 3. …*
Expected result	*Observable and measurable*
Postconditions	*Clean-up needed*
Automation candidate	*Yes / No / Done (link)*
Author / reviewer / date	

Execution record

Build	Date	Tester	Result (Pass/Fail/Blocked)	Evidence file	Defect ID

Defect Report

Purpose: Reproducible description of a failure (Stage 08). **Repository file:** `defects/DEF-nnn.md`

Defect ID / title	*DEF-nnn · what is wrong and where*
Reporter / date	
Environment	*Build, URL, browser/device, OS, data*
Module / requirement / test case	*REQ-nnn · TC-…*
Severity / priority (proposed)	*S1–S4 / High·Medium·Low*
Steps to reproduce	*Numbered; start from a known state*
Expected result	*With requirement reference*
Actual result	*What happened*

Frequency	*e.g. 3 of 3 attempts*
Evidence	*Screenshot / video / HAR / log file names (secrets removed)*
Workaround	*If any*
Status / assignee	*New · Assigned · Fixed · Retest · Closed · Reopened · Rejected · Duplicate · Deferred*
Fixed in build / retest result	

Test Execution Report

Purpose: Results of an execution cycle (Stages 07 and 12). **Repository file:** `docs/test-execution-report.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
1. Summary	*Period, build, environment, overall status (one paragraph).*
2. Scope tested / not tested	*Be explicit about gaps.*

3. Results

Planned	Executed	Passed	Failed	Blocked	Not run	Execution %	Pass rate

4. Defect summary	*Open/closed by severity; list S1/S2 with IDs.*
5. Coverage	*Requirement coverage %, automation coverage %, formulas stated.*
6. Environment and data issues	*Incidents affecting results.*
7. Risks and recommendations	*Facts, interpretation, recommendation separated.*
8. Evidence index	*Where evidence files are stored.*
9. Approvals	*QA Lead, Test Manager.*

Requirements Traceability Matrix

Purpose: Maps requirements to test cases, automation and defects. **Repository file:** `docs/requirements-traceability.md`

Rules	*Every requirement has ≥ 1 test case; every test case has a requirement; update on every change; coverage = requirements with ≥ 1 executed case ÷ total.*

Matrix

REQ ID	Requirement (short)	Risk	Test case IDs	Automated?	Last result	Defect IDs	Coverage status

Automation Coverage Report

Purpose: What is automated, stable and running (Stages 09 and 16). **Repository file:** `docs/automation-coverage.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
Summary metrics	*Total cases · automated · automation % (state denominator) · pass rate · suite runtime · flaky rate · last CI run link*
Candidates backlog	*Next tests to automate with ROI estimate*
Flaky register summary	*Open flaky tests, owners, ages*
Maintenance effort	*Hours this period*
Risks and limitations	*What automation does not cover*

Coverage by module

Module	Total cases	Automated	Automation %	Stable	Flaky	Notes

Performance Test Report

Purpose: Workload, thresholds, results and limitations (Stage 11). **Repository file:** `docs/performance-report.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
1. Objectives	*Questions this test answers.*
2. Environment	*Hardware, software, data volume, differences from production.*
3. Workload model	*Users, arrival rate, think time, scenarios, calculation.*
4. Tools and scripts	*Tool, version, script path, commit.*
5. Thresholds	*e.g. p95 < 500 ms; errors < 1 %.*

6. Results

Scenario	VUs	Throughput (req/s)	p50 (ms)	p95 (ms)	p99 (ms)	Error %

7. Server metrics	*CPU, memory, disk, network, connections.*
8. Analysis and bottlenecks	*Evidence-based; no speculation.*
9. Verdict against thresholds	*Pass / fail per threshold.*
10. Limitations	*What these results do not prove.*
11. Recommendations	*Actions with owners.*
12. Approvals	

UAT Report

Purpose: Client acceptance results (Stage 13). **Repository file:** `docs/uat-report.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*

Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
Scope and participants	*Business areas, UAT users, dates.*
Environment and data	*URL, build, accounts.*
Outstanding issues and decisions	*Each with owner and agreed action.*
Acceptance statement	*Accepted · accepted with conditions · not accepted.*
Signatures	*Client business owner, QA Lead, date.*

UAT results

Script ID	Business scenario	User	Result	Issue ID	Comment

Release QA Sign-off

Purpose: Evidence-based recommendation and unresolved-risk summary (Stage 14). **Repository file:** `docs/qa-signoff.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*
Release / build	*Version, date, environment.*
Evidence summary	*Execution %, pass rate, coverage, open defects by severity, automation result, performance and accessibility findings (with report links).*
Exit criteria check	*Each criterion from the plan: met / not met.*
Unresolved risks and waivers	*Risk, impact, owner, decision, date.*
QA recommendation	*☐ Go ☐ Conditional Go (conditions: …) ☐ No-Go*
Reviewer (second person)	*Name, date, comments.*
Client release decision	*Name, decision, date.*

Open defects at sign-off

ID	Severity	Summary	Decision (fix/waive)	Approver

Test Environment Description

Purpose: Describes the environment, accounts, data and tools (Stage 06). **Repository file:** `docs/test-environment.md`

Document ID / title	*e.g. QA-TP-001 · Test Plan*
Version / status	*0.1 draft · in review · approved*
Author / reviewer / approver	*Names and dates*
Project / client / build	*Names and build identifiers*

1. Environments

Name	URL	Purpose	Owner	Build / version

2. Accounts and access	*Role, account name (never passwords), who authorised it in writing, expiry.*
3. Test data sets	*Synthetic only; purpose and refresh rule of each set.*
4. Browser / device / OS versions	*Exact versions installed or leased.*
5. Monitoring and logs	*Where testers and developers can see logs and metrics.*
6. Refresh, backup and reset rules	*Who resets, how often, how testers are told.*
7. Known limitations	*Differences from production; unavailable integrations (stubbed).*
8. Readiness checklist (Gate G6)	*☐ build deployed ☐ smoke passed ☐ data loaded ☐ accounts verified ☐ no production data present*
9. Approvals	*QA Lead, client technical lead, date.*

Client Qualification Record

Purpose: Go / no-go for a new engagement (Stage 01). **Repository file:** `docs/client-qualification.md`

Client / contact / decision maker	
Product and users	
Technology stack and environments	
Release cadence	
Testing needs and services wanted	
Existing test assets / tools	
Compliance / accessibility needs	
Timeline and budget range	
Red flags (guarantees, production testing, no environment ...)	
NDA signed (date)	
Capacity and skills check	
Decision and approver	*Proceed · decline · request more information*

QA sign-off checklist

Complete before every release recommendation (Stage 14). Every box ticked needs a reference to evidence; the second reviewer re-checks a sample.

Scope and plan

- [ ] Approved test strategy and plan are in the repository, versioned.
- [ ] Scope changes since approval are recorded and approved.
- [ ] Entry criteria were met before execution began (Gate G6).

Execution

- [ ] All planned critical cases executed; counts reconcile (passed + failed + blocked + not run = planned).
- [ ] Every result has evidence; evidence contains no secrets or personal data.
- [ ] Regression exit criteria met (Gate G12).

Defects

- [ ] All Severity 1 and 2 defects are fixed and verified, or waived in writing by the product owner.
- [ ] Every deferred defect is in the risk summary with an owner.
- [ ] No defect was closed without a verified retest.

Coverage and automation

- [ ] Requirement coverage computed and uncovered requirements listed.
- [ ] Automation results attached; flaky tests reported separately.
- [ ] Known defects marked as expected failures reference defect IDs.

Non-functional

- [ ] Performance report approved, with limitations stated (or explicitly out of scope).
- [ ] Accessibility findings listed against WCAG criteria (or out of scope).
- [ ] Security observations handed to the named coordinator.

UAT and release

- [ ] UAT acceptance signed (or not required by contract).
- [ ] Production smoke list, accounts, window and rollback decision-maker agreed.
- [ ] Second reviewer checked numbers against raw data.

Records

- [ ] Metrics have formulas, dates, builds and sources.
- [ ] Recommendation is Go / Conditional Go / No-Go and follows from the evidence.
- [ ] Evidence is archived per the retention rule; no real customer data exists in the repository.

Role	Name	Signature	Date	Decision
QA Lead				
Second reviewer (Test Manager)				
Client release owner				